Teaching Statement

My teaching philosophy centers on equipping students with a broad understanding of economic methodologies while emphasizing their practical applications to real-world problems. I believe that economics education should extend beyond theoretical knowledge and encourage students to develop the skills necessary to independently investigate economic questions. In particular, I hope to foster an educational environment in which students are exposed to diverse analytical approaches, gain hands-on experience with empirical research, and recognize the expanding possibilities offered by emerging computational technologies.

One of my primary teaching objectives is to introduce students to a wide range of economic topics and research methodologies. While developing expertise in a particular field is valuable, I believe that exposure to diverse approaches is equally important. Researchers cannot readily apply methodologies with potential relevance if they have never learned about them. By introducing students to different econometric techniques, theoretical frameworks, and computational tools, I hope to broaden their perspectives and help them recognize alternative approaches to research questions. I would emphasize the underlying intuition, practical applications, and relative strengths and limitations of techniques, more than the technical aspects. This approach would provide students with foundation for independently pursuing specialized knowledge.

A second priority is to place empirical research at the center of econometrics education. Although understanding statistical theories is essential, I believe that firsthand experience with real-world data offers equally valuable learning opportunities. I would therefore incorporate practical research projects in which students identify economic questions, locate appropriate datasets, clean and organize raw information, conduct empirical analyses, and present their findings in written reports. Such projects would expose students to challenges frequently overlooked in conventional textbook exercises. Through these experiences, I hope students will develop not only technical proficiency in statistical software, but also the critical judgment required to conduct credible empirical research.

I am also interested in incorporating recent developments in AI and natural language processing into economics education. Advances in machine learning have made it increasingly feasible to analyze unstructured information, particularly textual data that previously required substantial manual processing. These data represent a rich and often underused sources of economic information; my own research on public attitudes toward climate change illustrates how computational techniques can transform unstructured text into economically meaningful evidence. I would like to introduce students to these emerging methodologies.

My broader research experience in environmental economics and econometrics would also inform my teaching. My work on California's cap-and-trade program and difference-in-differences methodologies provides opportunities to connect econometric concepts with practical policy evaluation. I would use such applications to illustrate how economic theory, identification strategies, and empirical evidence interact when addressing real policy questions.

Ultimately, my goal as an educator is to help students become independent and adaptable researchers. By combining methodological breadth, practical empirical training, and exposure to emerging analytical tools, I hope to prepare students not only to understand existing economic research but also to identify new questions and develop effective strategies for answering them.